The Reversed Alternate Uses Task (rAUT)

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The rAUT is a newly developed domain-general divergent thinking measure that conceptually reverses the instructions of the AUT. Instead of generating unusual uses for given objects (as in the AUT), participants are instructed to come up with as many unusual or surprising objects that could be used for the given purposes within the allocated time (e.g., two minutes per item in our study). The items may be assigned in a random order to minimize the order and fatigue effects.

Here are the instructions and items that could be used in your study.

Instructions: Please list as many unusual or surprising objects that you can think of that could be used for the following purposes. Use all your time to come up with as many unique objects as you can. There are __ items you will have to complete. In each prompt, when the 2 minutes are up, you will be asked to stop generating responses and move to the next item.

rAUT Items

Item	Item Text
	What are unusual or surprising objects that you could use …
1	for carrying supplies in?
2	to store food in?
3	to keep warm?
4	to dig with?
5	to write with?
6	as a weapon?
7	to start a fire?
8	to eat with?
9	to exercise with?
10	to travel across campus?

Responses are scored based on three components: Fluency, Originality, and Elaboration. Fluency refers to the number of ideas a participant generates in an allotted timeframe. Originality can be defined as the unusualness, uncommonness, or surprisingness of the ideas. Elaboration is operationalized as the number of words within the verbal response to the prompt.